

The Sacrament of Holy Matrimony

By Dn Yonnas · Sacraments · Youth & Young Adults

Summary

Holy Matrimony is the sacrament through which bridegroom and bride are united and granted divine grace that sanctifies their union, making it like the unity of Christ and His Church. The lesson covers its institution in both Testaments, its divine goals, the outward signs and invisible grace, and the obligations of husband and wife.

Lesson Objectives

- Define Matrimony as a sacrament, not merely a contract or ceremony
- Trace its institution from Genesis through Christ's teaching
- Understand the outward signs and the invisible grace of the sacrament

Key Bible Verses

Genesis 1:27–28 — male and female He created them; be fruitful and multiply

Matthew 19:4–6 — "what God has joined together, let not man separate"

Ephesians 5:25 — "Husbands, love your wives, just as Christ also loved the church"

Main Teaching Points

- Marriage was instituted by God in Eden and sealed by Christ as a sacrament
- Its goals: the growth of mankind, mutual help, and a holy guard against temptation
- Every sacrament has an outward sign and an invisible grace
- The grace of Matrimony sanctifies the union as Christ's unity with the Church
- Both spouses must be Christians within the Orthodox Church for the sacrament
- Matrimony is performed in the Church; faithfulness and unity follow it for life

Key Terms

- **Sacrament (Mystery)** — A holy act through which invisible divine grace is given by means of a visible sign.
- **Outward Sign** — What we can see and hear in a sacrament — words, actions, and elements.
- **Invisible Grace** — The real divine gift granted through the sacrament, beyond what eyes can see.
- **Crowning** — The visible rite of Orthodox marriage, crowning the couple into their new life in Christ.

Discussion & Reflection

- What makes Orthodox marriage different from a civil wedding?
- Why does St. Paul compare marriage to Christ and the Church?
- How should young people prepare now for a holy marriage later?